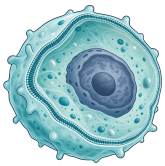
From a disease question to a candidate decision

1 Disease and mechanism



Decision

Causal relevance

- Frequent failure

Correlation as mechanism

2 Target identification



Decision

Actionable entity

- Frequent failure

Identity collapse

3 Target validation



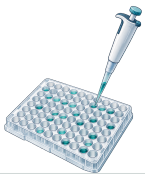
Decision

Phenotype change

- Frequent failure

Evidence reuse

4 Assay and data strategy



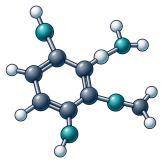
Decision

Optimisation quantity

- Frequent failure

Pooled endpoints

5 Hit discovery



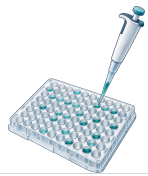
Decision

Worth confirming?

- Frequent failure

Retrospective as prospective

6 Hit confirmation



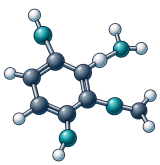
Decision

Attributable activity

- Frequent failure

Artefact as binding

7 Hit-to-lead



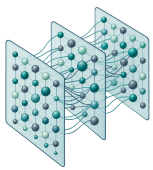
Decision

Series headroom

- Frequent failure

Endpoint loss

8 Lead optimisation



Decision

Acceptable trade-off

- Frequent failure

Scalar hides liability

9 Candidate nomination



Decision

Package coherence

- Frequent failure

Confidence as experiment

Read every row left to right. Wrapped arrows indicate order; diamonds identify frequent failures.

Conceptual illustrations; native labels and relationships.